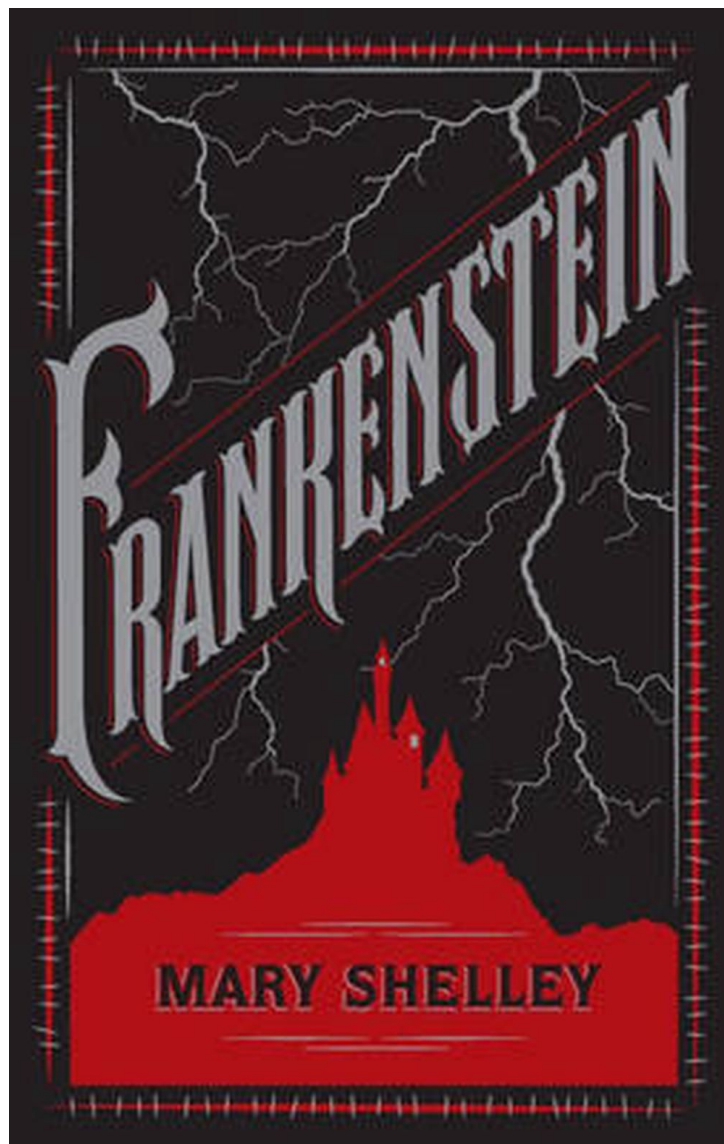


Frankenstein: A Literary Analysis

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1 Introduction

Mary Shelley's *Frankenstein* (1818) is a novel that blends Gothic horror with philosophical reflection. This analysis focuses on the extract where Victor Frankenstein describes the moment he brings the Creature to life. Through this passage, Shelley explores ambition, isolation, and the ethical consequences of creation. The introduction sets the stage for examining how Shelley warns against unchecked scientific progress and the absence of empathy. At the same time, the novel reflects broader nineteenth-century anxieties about the limits of human knowledge and the dangers of transgressing natural boundaries.

2 Ambition and Isolation in Frankenstein

Victor Frankenstein's relentless pursuit of knowledge reflects the dangers of ambition without responsibility. In the chosen extract, Victor's excitement quickly turns to horror as he realizes the consequences of his actions. The Creature, rejected by society, suffers from isolation and prejudice, which ultimately drive him toward violence. Shelley suggests that both Victor and his creation are victims of neglect and lack of compassion. Scholars such as Mellor argue that Victor's ambition reflects Romantic anxieties about science Mellor 1989, while Baldick emphasizes the novel's role in shaping cultural ideas of monstrosity Baldick 1987. The tension between creator and creation illustrates how ambition, when divorced from empathy, produces destructive outcomes. Shelley's narrative also anticipates modern debates about scientific ethics, foreshadowing concerns about biotechnology, artificial intelligence, and the responsibilities of innovators.

3 Conclusion

Shelley's novel is more than a Gothic tale; it is a meditation on ambition, responsibility, and compassion. By portraying both Victor and the Creature as tragic figures, she warns against the dangers of progress without empathy. *Frankenstein* remains relevant today, reminding us that scientific and technological advances must always be guided by ethical responsibility. The novel's enduring power lies in its ability to raise timeless questions: What does it mean to be human, and what obligations do we owe to the beings we create? In this way, Shelley's work continues to challenge readers to reflect on the moral dimensions of knowledge and innovation.

References

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